

CIVICVIEW, INC. — EIN Filing Guide

FL Sunbiz doc # P26000027545 · Incorporated 2026-05-21

Current status

IRS online EIN assistant blocks you at the Identity step. Verified via IRS Online Account that IRS records show your name correctly as JEFFREY DE LA NUEZ. SSN is correct. You have applied for EINs before for two prior businesses, which is the most likely cause of the block (the IRS online tool sometimes refuses subsequent applications from the same responsible party). Girlfriend's separate application went through, which corroborates the per-responsible-party theory.

Decision: file Form SS-4 by fax. Backup option: call the IRS Business & Specialty Tax Line at 7:00 AM ET sharp.

Step-by-step plan

1. Try the online tool one final time at 7:00 AM ET in incognito on a fresh browser, just in case the validator clears overnight. (5-minute attempt.)
2. If still blocked, sign up at fax.plus and note the virtual fax number assigned to you.
3. Download SS-4 from irs.gov/pub/irs-pdf/fss4.pdf.
4. Fill in the form using the line-by-line table on the next page. Yellow-highlighted rows are personal info you fill in by hand — DO NOT type your SSN into any shared file.
5. Sign the form (Fax.Plus has a built-in signature tool, or print + sign by hand + scan).
6. Fax to 855-641-6935. Save the Fax.Plus transmission receipt as proof of send.
7. Wait 1-4 business days. IRS faxes the EIN confirmation (Form CP 575) back to your Fax.Plus virtual number.
8. Save the CP 575 PDF — it's the canonical proof of your EIN. You will need it for Stripe, the business bank account, and GoFundMe.

SS-4 line-by-line prefill

Yellow-highlighted rows = fill in by hand. Bold rows are the critical fields where mistakes cost time.

Line	Field	What to enter
1	Legal name of entity	CIVICVIEW, INC.
2	Trade name (if different)	CIVICVIEW (or leave blank — same as line 1)
3	Executor, administrator, trustee, "care of" name	Leave blank — not applicable for a new corp
4a	Mailing address — street + suite	[YOUR HOME STREET ADDRESS, e.g. 1234 Main St]
4b	City, state, ZIP	[YOUR CITY], FL [YOUR ZIP]
5a	Street address (if different from 4a)	Leave blank — same as mailing
5b	City/state/ZIP (if different)	Leave blank
6	County and state of principal business location	[YOUR COUNTY], FL (e.g. Miami-Dade, FL)
7a	Responsible party — full name	JEFFREY DE LA NUEZ
7b	SSN or ITIN of responsible party	[FILL IN BY HAND — DO NOT TYPE INTO ANY SHARED FILE]
8a	Is this an LLC?	No (CIVICVIEW is a Corporation, not an LLC)
8b	Number of LLC members	Leave blank
8c	LLC organized in US?	Leave blank
9a	Type of entity (check ONE)	✓ CORPORATION (enter form number to be filed): 1120
9b	State / foreign country of incorporation	State: FL Foreign country: (blank)
10	Reason for applying (check ONE)	✓ Started new business (specify type): Civic engagement software platform
11	Date business started	05/21/2026 (your Sunbiz incorporation date)
12	Closing month of accounting year	December
13	Highest # of employees expected next 12 months (Agricultural / Household / Other)	Agricultural: 0 Household: 0 Other: 0 (or your estimate if hiring)
14	File Form 944 annually instead of 941 quarterly?	Leave unchecked (default = quarterly Form 941). If you expect <\$1,000 in payroll for the year, can check Yes.
15	First date wages or annuities were paid	N/A (no employees yet)
16	Principal activity of business (check ONE)	✓ OTHER (specify): Civic engagement software platform

Line	Field	What to enter
17	Specific products/services	Web platform connecting U.S. citizens with their elected representatives and candidates
18	Has the entity ever applied for + received an EIN before?	No (CIVICVIEW, INC. is brand new — prior EINs were for your OTHER businesses, not this entity)
—	Third Party Designee section	Leave all four lines blank — you're filing for yourself
—	Name and title (print clearly)	JEFFREY DE LA NUEZ — President (or Founder / Sole Director)
—	Signature	[SIGN BY HAND or via Fax.Plus signature tool]
—	Date	[FILING DATE]
—	Applicant's telephone number	[YOUR PHONE — IRS may call with questions]
—	Applicant's fax number	[YOUR FAX.PLUS VIRTUAL FAX NUMBER — IRS faxes EIN to this number]

Notes on the trickier fields

Line 9a — Type of entity

Check the 'Corporation' box and enter '1120' as the form to be filed. This files you as a default C-corporation. You can elect S-corporation taxation later via Form 2553 if your attorney recommends it — that election does not require a new EIN.

Line 10 — Reason for applying

Check 'Started new business' and on the line provided enter: 'Civic engagement software platform'. Do not check the 'Banking purpose' or 'Compliance with IRS withholding' boxes — those are for different scenarios.

Line 13 — Highest number of employees

Enter your honest expected employee counts for the next 12 months. If you'll be hiring contractors only (1099) and no W-2 employees, all three boxes can be zero. If you expect to hire any W-2 employees in the next year, estimate.

Line 16 — Principal activity

Check 'Other' and write: 'Civic engagement software platform'. The IRS's pre-listed categories (Construction, Real estate, etc.) don't fit; 'Other' is correct.

Line 18b — Applicant's fax number

This is the most-missed field. The IRS faxes your EIN reply to this number. If wrong or blank, the reply goes into the void. Double-check this matches your Fax.Plus virtual number exactly.

E-fax service options

Pick one. All five work; the differences are pricing model and brand maturity.

Service	Pricing	Notes
Fax.Plus (RECOMMENDED)	Free 7-day trial (~10 pages outbound + inbound)	Pay-per-fax model on paid tiers. Free trial easily covers a single SS-4 send (2-3 pages) + receiving the IRS reply. fax.plus
eFax	Free trial, then ~\$17/mo	Biggest brand. Free trial works for one send. SET A CANCELLATION REMINDER — they auto-bill aggressively. efax.com
HelloFax	Free trial	Owned by Dropbox. Clean UX. Free trial covers a single send. hellofax.com
iFax	Free trial	Decent alternative if Fax.Plus is unavailable. ifaxapp.com
RingCentral Fax	Free trial, then \$20+/mo	Heavier setup — skip unless you want to keep fax permanently for other business use. ringcentral.com

IRS contact details

Channel	Details
Fax SS-4 to IRS	855-641-6935 (toll-free; for entities in the 50 states + DC). The IRS faxes the EIN reply back to the number you list on line 18b within 1-4 business days.
IRS Business & Specialty Tax Line (phone)	800-829-4933 (Mon-Fri, 7am-7pm local time). Best chance of getting through: call at 7:00 AM ET sharp. They can issue an EIN over the phone in some cases.
Online EIN tool (currently blocking you)	irs.gov/businesses/small-businesses-self-employed/apply-for-an-employer-identification-number-ein-online — keep retrying at 7:00 AM ET in incognito + on a fresh browser, just in case the validator clears.
SS-4 form download	irs.gov/pub/irs-pdf/fss4.pdf (2-page fillable PDF)
SS-4 instructions	irs.gov/pub/irs-pdf/iss4.pdf (8-page guide)

After the EIN arrives

- Save the CP 575 PDF from the IRS fax reply. Multiple copies — Drive, email, your Keys folder.
- Update Pinecone memory + Task #21 with the actual EIN value (or at least mark #21 complete).
- Proceed to Task #22 (Stripe test) — Stripe verification asks for the EIN.
- Open the business bank account (Task #23) — bank also asks for the EIN + CP 575.
- Set up GoFundMe campaign (Task #24) — GoFundMe charity registration uses the EIN.
- Plan the Sunbiz Articles of Amendment (Task #18) with the attorney (Task #27) to convert to Benefit Corporation status. EIN does not change during this conversion.

Things to NOT do

- Do NOT use a free fax-receive-only service (like Faxburner free tier) — the IRS faxes the EIN back, so you need a service that BOTH sends and receives.
- Do NOT use a PO box for line 4a — the IRS requires a physical street address (some PO box-style services with a 'street address' format work; pure PO boxes don't).
- Do NOT apply through a third-party EIN service if you're already paying for an attorney consult — the attorney can do it as part of the engagement at no extra cost.
- Do NOT elect S-corp on the SS-4 — that's a Form 2553 conversation with the attorney first.
- Do NOT share your SSN with any third party (including this guide). Fill line 7b by hand on the printed/saved form.

If the fax route fails for any reason

The fallbacks, in order:

- Call 800-829-4933 at 7:00 AM ET — they can issue an EIN by phone in some cases.
- Engage a third-party filing service (Bizee, LegalZoom): \$70-\$150, EIN typically delivered in 1-3 business days. Slower than fax but with hand-holding.
- Mail SS-4 to the IRS address in the SS-4 instructions: 4-5 weeks. Last resort.

Generated by Claude Cowork for Jeffrey De La Nuez. Treat the personal-info blanks (yellow-highlighted) as private — fill them by hand on your printed or PDF copy, never in a shared file.